

Habit & Budget Tracker — Scope, Limitations & FAQ

Scope and Limitations

What's included:

- Full create/view/edit/delete for Budgets, Budget Periods, Accounts, Account Types, Categories, Transactions, and Transaction Types (Budget Tracker).
- Full create/view/edit/delete for Projects, Tasks, and Labels (Task Tracker). Every Task has a date, an optional stricter deadline, a priority level, and can be set to repeat.
- The main feature:
 - adding an unpaid bill automatically creates a matching task. If the bill repeats (like rent every month), the task repeats too and comes back on its own each time.
 - Repeating income (like a monthly paycheck) does NOT create a task — there's nothing to remind someone to pay.
- One budget per account, and the user picks how often it resets (weekly, monthly, every 3 months, twice a year, once a year, or a custom period).
- One login per user (no separate accounts for the budget side and the task side).
- A monthly summary of spending by category and account, plus a streak count for tasks the user keeps finishing on time.

What's not included (first version):

- Connecting directly to a real bank account or moving real money — the app only records what the user types in; it doesn't touch actual funds.
- Any kind of automatic money advice or AI-generated suggestions.
- Support for more than one currency at a time.
- Working without an internet connection, or a separate app for phones (it works in a phone's browser instead).
- Two people sharing/linking their accounts together (this is a "nice to have" for later, not promised in the first version).

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Q: Isn't this just two separate apps stuck together?

A: No. Both sides use the same login and the same database, and they actually affect each other — finishing a task can automatically mark a bill as paid. Two unrelated apps can't do that; they'd need the user to update both by hand.

Q: Why would someone use this instead of a normal budgeting app plus a normal to-do app (like Todoist)?

A: Because those two kinds of apps don't talk to each other. A banking app only tells you about a missed payment after you've already missed it. A to-do app like Todoist has no idea what a "bill" even is. This app turns a bill into a task the moment it's created, so the reminder shows up before the due date, not after.

Q: Why not just connect to real bank accounts if that would make the app more useful?

A: It would help, but doing it safely and correctly takes much more time and security work than a 5-week project allows. It's something we'd want to add in a future version, not something we're promising now.

Q: If there's no bank connection, how is people's money data kept safe?

A: The basics are still covered — passwords are stored securely (not in plain text), and only logged-in users can see their own data. Because we're not connecting to real banks, we also avoid the riskiest part of handling financial apps: storing someone's actual bank login or card details.

Q: Is the Todoist/Atomic Habits inspiration just for looks, or does it actually change how the app works?

A: It actually changes how the app works, not just how it looks. The "repeat" setting (borrowed from Todoist) is what makes a task come back on its own instead of disappearing after it's done — that's a real feature, not just styling. And wording tasks as a personal habit ("I pay rent on time") instead of a plain checkbox is meant to actually help people stick with it, based on ideas from the book Atomic Habits.